

STEPGEN · DESIGN DECISIONS REGISTER

StepGen design decisions register

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DOCUMENT CONTROL

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Project TRL	TRL 3 Proof of concept		
Repository	github.com/BoujeeEnjinia1701/stepgen		
Source	docs/06-design-decisions.md @ uncommitted		

REVISION HISTORY

Version	Date	Author	Change
0.2	2026-10-02	Amish Chadha	Amish approved the recommendations for all seven open decisions (2026-10-02); SGN-DDR-003 accepted; moved to decisions made
0.1	2026-10-01	Amish Chadha	Register opened; open decisions gathered from the review note, the decision records and the build plan work

StepGen design decisions register

Every design decision still to be made, and every decision made, in one place. Each decision is argued in full in its decision record under `docs/decisions/` ; this register is the index Amish works from. The build plan (`docs/05-build-plan.md`) describes the design as it stands and does not list open decisions.

■ Open decisions

None. All open decisions were decided on 2026-10-02.

■ To confirm when parts are bought

#	What to confirm	Why it matters	Source
1	The fork: 1 1/8 in threadless rigid steel, 26 in size (axle to crown about 410 mm), 30 mm offset, post-mount disc tabs, steerer 220 mm or longer. If only 38 to 45 mm offsets are found, trail falls from 58 mm to about 42 to 49 mm	Sets trail and steering feel; a 20 in fork is too short for the head tube	SGN-DDR-003 P4
2	The head tube is machined for a ZS44 headset and the headset's crown race fits the fork	The headset must fit both	SGN-DDR-003 P4
3	The walking-pad treadmill: belt 400 mm or wider, end rollers about 50 mm and 420 mm long, bearings 6203 size on fixed axles that can be drilled and tapped	The one-way bearing (CSK17) and the axle fixings assume these	SGN-DDR-003 P8
4	The idler rollers' spring axles: 8 mm round or hex	Sets the carrier bar hole size	SGN-DDR-003 P10
5	The hub motor: 135 mm axle width, axle flats that take the torque arms, 6-bolt rotor mount	Sets the dropout spacing and the rear brake	SGN-DDR-003 P2, P3
6	The controller fits a 150 x 70 x 40 mm space and has a brake-cut input that both levers and the lanyard can open	Sets the controller plate and the cut-off wiring	SGN-DDR-003 P14
7	The SwapCell pack's guide faces and handle end match the cradle (interface v0.3 envelope)	Sets the cradle's inside width and the lever pad	SGN-DDR-003 P13
8	The second-hand prices: about USD 40 for a walking-pad treadmill and USD 50 for a donor 20 in bike	The reference build cost depends on them	SGN-DDR-002 item 1

■ Value engineering

Value-engineering target: USD 650 (a hypothetical control target, not a limit). Estimated cost of the constructable design: USD 610 on the salvage reference build, pack excluded (USD 40 under the target); USD 750 with all new parts (USD 100 over the target). Main cost drivers and savings worth trying:

- The largest lines are the rear wheel with its hub motor (USD 110), the belt and end rollers (USD 97 new, from about USD 40 salvaged with the idlers), the main frame (USD 92, of which USD 25 is the machined head tube), the front wheel, fork and headset (USD 70), and the receiver cradle (USD 55, of which USD 30 is the receptacle).
- Making the design constructable raised the reference build from USD 546 to USD 610: about USD 40 because the donor bike's fork is too short for the head tube, and the rest for the nose beam, head tube, carrier bars, guards, fender, rivet nuts and fixings.
- Savings worth trying: a donor bike with a 26 in fork as well as a 20 in front wheel would save the USD 40 fork; a donor walking pad whose rollers already take a one-way bearing saves the bearing; buying the receptacle with the SwapCell project's batch may halve its price.

■ Decisions made

Date	Decision	Decided by	Record
2026-09-24	StepGen becomes a walking-treadmill vehicle; the stationary stepper generator is dropped	Amish: "as the person walks his scooter / bike moves forward but hes upright walking instead of pedalling"	SGN-PRB-001, SGN-PRC-001
2026-09-25	TRL 2 review items: two-wheel long-wheelbase form, 20 in wheels, 250 W rear hub with a 25 km/h cut and 15 km/h beginner mode, 30 km range target, no roller generator, Mobility and Logistics area, USD 650 budget (pack excluded), legal route, SwapCell interface v0.3, shared-pack pricing, co-design partners later	Amish: "proceed with all of your recommendations across all batches. Make sure we don't proceed to TRL 4 on any of them."	SGN-DDR-001
2026-09-25	Salvage route as the reference build within USD 650; belt kept at 1.05 m until co-design; 60 x 30 x 2 mm deck rails; key switch in the INTERLOCK loop; raise the legacy-to-heartbeat question with SwapCell	Amish: "i accept all your recommendations, go with them across all repos."	SGN-DDR-002
2026-09-30	Make the design physically buildable while drawing the build plan; keep outstanding decisions out of the build plan, in this register	Amish: "If you are realising that the design cannot be built as per concept - fix the design assumptions to match and be physically feasible as you draw the illustrations."	SGN-DDR-003 (accepted on 2026-10-02, below)
2026-10-01	<code>budget_usd</code> is a value-engineering target, not a limit	Amish: "the budgets are a hypothetical control target to ensure we are thinking along a value engineering lens"	This register, Value engineering
2026-10-02	Design for construction accepted: P1 to P17 and their knock-on changes, as made	Amish: "i approve your recommendations for all 555 open decisions."	SGN-DDR-003
2026-10-02	First user group: non-cycling adults of working age who walk or take transit, with older adults as the second group once balance is understood	Amish: "i approve your recommendations for all 555 open decisions."	SGN-DDR-001 item 13, SGN-DDR-002 item 6
2026-10-02	First target country for the legal category: the Netherlands, confirming the category with the Dutch vehicle authority (RDW) before any road use; the first country to approach, not a confirmed category	Amish: "i approve your recommendations for all 555 open decisions."	SGN-DDR-001 items 8 and 14, SGN-DDR-002 item 7
2026-10-02	Rider pose: the shorter stride is accepted for the renders, and stride length on the 1.0 m belt is added to the co-design checks	Amish: "i approve your recommendations for all 555 open decisions."	docs/ REVIEW.md , 2026-09-26, item 1
2026-10-02	Wheel detail: 28 laced spokes and rotor carriers accepted as appearance only; the rotor carriers are confirmed when the wheel build is specified	Amish: "i approve your recommendations for all 555 open decisions."	docs/ REVIEW.md , 2026-09-26, item 3
2026-10-02	Branding: the wordmark, pinstripe and accent colours are the reference scheme; the "250 W 25		docs/ REVIEW.md ,

Date	Decision	Decided by	Record
	km/h" rating decal is dropped from the renders until the legal category is confirmed	Amish: "i approve your recommendations for all 555 open decisions."	2026-09-26, item 4
2026-10-02	Three-wheel version: keep two wheels for now and make balance a fixed co-design test: if most non-cyclists cannot ride at walking pace after a short trial, the three-wheel version is designed	Amish: "i approve your recommendations for all 555 open decisions."	SGN-DDR-001 item 1